

BRIAN A. CHESKO

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Relativity Space – Stennis Space Center, MS

2021 ... present

Ground Software Engineer, Lead | April 2026 – Present

- Leading Ground Software's full-stack *Platform* group focusing on user experience, user-led system management, and platform deployment infrastructure for a safety-critical control software environment
- **C++ / Go systems design:** Rescoped and shipped an MVP Go/gRPC overhaul for C++ configuration deployment and state management functionality in 4 weeks after direct operator interviews revealed it as a high-priority unmet need, then iterating to full delivery
- Overseeing 4 direct reports while continuing all previous IC duties

Senior Ground Software Engineer | Dec 2024 – April 2026

- **C++ systems:** Built and maintained full-stack low-latency Linux data acquisition and control services in a modern C++ distributed pub/sub architecture, achieving sub-millisecond control authority (C++23, DDS)
- Co-owned Kubernetes deployment infrastructure-as-code (IaC) across 20+ independent edge (K0s) and bare-metal environments, migrating critical systemd services to enable automatic restarts, controlled rollouts, and improved operational resilience, including custom Helm charts, pipelines, and monitoring
- **Developer tooling:** Created developer CLI and pipeline tooling to improve and automate dev processes ranging from one-off tools to fully representative local deployment environments (Go, Python, Bash, K3d)
- **CI/build systems:** Built and rolled out a Bazel-based remote-cache friendly application configuration framework (Starlark rules/macros/providers, etc.) used by 100+ semi-technical operators and re-architected GitLab CI pipelines, cutting median execution time from 20 to 5 min (Bazel, Gitlab CI/CD, GoogleTest, Pytest)

Ground Software Engineer II | Feb 2023 – Dec 2024

- **Infrastructure/Go systems design:** Architected and delivered a full-stack internal platform-as-a-service for provisioning, upgrading, configuring, and monitoring 100+ bare-metal hosts and industrial PCs across multiple geographic locations (Go, Ansible, Docker, Helm + Kubernetes, gRPC)
- Built the full application layer: REST/gRPC APIs, database schemas, OpenTelemetry observability dashboards, and a React/TypeScript front-end, giving 30+ power-user operators a unified interface for managing their ground systems at scale
- **C++ systems:** Refactored a performance-critical C++ service from a blocking multithreaded model to an event-driven architecture using Boost.Asio, reducing contention and improving responsiveness under load

Ground Software Engineer I | Oct 2021 – Feb 2023

- Built tooling for operators to facilitate creation of custom GUIs in the Ignition SCADA, enabling 30+ operators across 3 sites to tailor daily operational uses to their own needs
- Supported operators during high-stakes test and launch operations with real-time support, rapidly diagnosing issues and safely patching live systems when necessary

EDUCATION + INTERNSHIPS

Rowan University, Glassboro, NJ

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | May 2021

Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering | May 2021

Honors Concentration; Minor in Mathematics

NASA Glenn Research Center (Remote)

Software Engineering Intern, Electrified Aircraft Propulsion Project | Summer 2020

- Developed real-time Simulink simulation components for a high-lift motor controller system

Clover Network, Inc.

Software Engineering Intern (Backend → Frontend) | Summer 2018, Summer 2019

- Built RESTful API endpoints and associated frontend components on a Java/Hibernate/React stack